

Carnival History

Welcome to Notting Hill Carnival!

Celebrating 60 years of incredible music, vibrant colours, and rich Caribbean culture, Notting Hill Carnival is London's biggest street party—welcoming over two million people of all ages for an unforgettable weekend of joy, dance, and community spirit!

How the Magic Began What started as a grassroots community gathering has blossomed into a world-renowned cultural institution:

- **1959 (The Spark):** Activist Claudia Jones organised an indoor Caribbean showcase at St Pancras Town Hall to bring people together and lift spirits through calypso and steelpan.
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- **1966 (Taking to the Streets):** Community leader Rhaune Laslett launched the first outdoor street festival featuring local children dressed in colourful characters alongside Trinidadian steelpan players and brass bands.
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- **1973 (The Sound System Era):** Leslie "Teacher" Palmer introduced static street sound systems and costume floats across Ladbroke Grove, creating the electric outdoor experience we know today.
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What to See & Experience

- **The Spectacular Mas Parade:** Marvel at breathtaking masquerade dancers in glittering, hand-crafted costumes with towering feather headdresses dancing along the parade route.
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- **Thunderous Steelbands:** Feel the uplifting, melodic harmonies of live steelpan orchestras and drum troupes that keep crowds swaying from morning to night.
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- **Legendary Sound Systems:** Discover dozens of iconic sound stages across West London—widely known as the "World Cup" of sound system culture—spinning everything from roots reggae and calypso to high-energy soca, bouyon, and house.
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- **Delicious Caribbean Flavours:** Follow the smoky, mouth-watering aromas of classic jerk chicken, warm roti, fried plantains, and sweet treats from stalls across the neighbourhood.
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- **Family Day Fun:** Carnival Sunday is traditionally dedicated to children and families, featuring the junior mas parade and welcoming spaces for young ones to dance and explore.
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Carnival is all about sharing love, cultural pride, and pure happiness across generations. Put on your brightest colours, bring the family, and come ready to celebrate!

Suggested In-App Photos

- **Photo 1 (Top Hero):** A smiling mas dancer in a vibrant, multi-coloured feathered costume dancing with the crowd along the sunlit parade route.
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- **Photo 2 (Mid-Page):** A lively shot of a live steel drum orchestra performing alongside an energetic, all-ages audience.